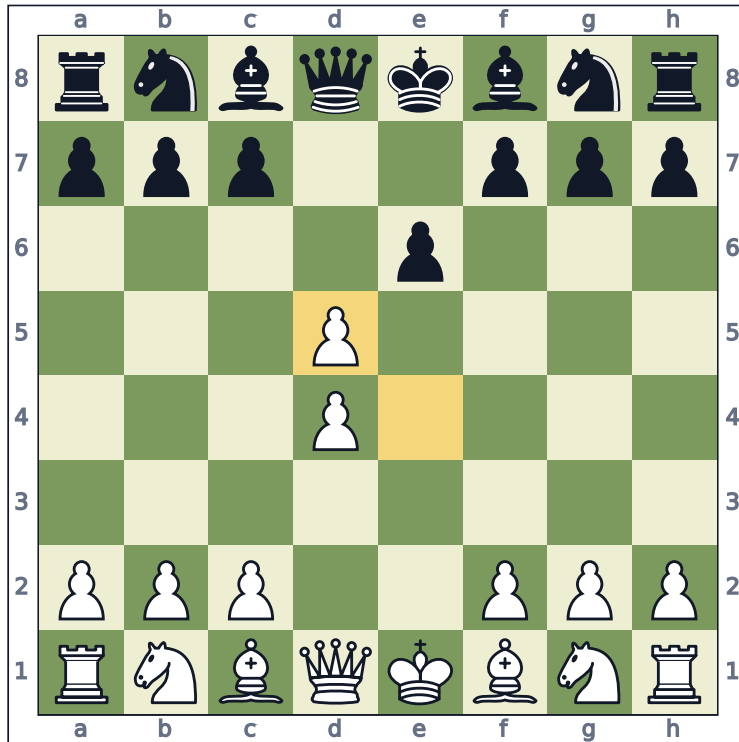


FRENCH DEFENSE

French Defense

ECO C01 | 6 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.23 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C01 covers French Defense. Black builds a d5-e6 center and accepts a temporarily restricted c8 bishop in exchange for a clear attack on White's center. The diagram uses the featured line French Defense: Exchange Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, support the e5 chain when it exists, and develop before beginning a kingside attack.

BLACK'S GOALS

Challenge d4 with ...c5, attack e5 with ...f6 when sound, and solve the c8 bishop deliberately.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...c5 is the basic break; ...f6 is the second. White often uses c3, f4-f5, or queenside play depending on the structure.

PIECE MAP

White's e5 pawn can gain space but needs support. Black's bad bishop often becomes active after ...b6 and ...Ba6 or after exchanges. The material imbalance means development and compensation must be calculated, not assumed.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Both sides can misjudge the pawn chain: attack its base and calculate breaks rather than attacking where the chain is strongest. Do not judge the gambit only by the pawn count; compare king safety, tempi, and open lines.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. White is ahead by about 1 pawn unit. Central markers: White pawn on d4, White pawn on d5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A sound, excellent defense with clear plans and rich counterplay, though cramped positions require patience.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C01 line

This section preserves all 6 names and defining routes assigned to C01 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 French Defense: Exchange Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5

002 French Defense: Exchange Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 exd5 4. Nc3

003 French Defense: Exchange Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 exd5 4. Nf3

004 French Defense: Exchange Variation, Bogoljubow Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 exd5 4. Nc3 Nf6 5. Bg5 Nc6

005 French Defense: Exchange Variation, Monte Carlo Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 exd5 4. c4

006 French Defense: Exchange Variation, Svenonius Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. exd5 exd5 5. Bg5